

Alper Polat - Resume

Top Skills

Infrastructure as Code (IaC) / Configuration Management

"Making sure we have scalable and maintainable infrastructure. Cattle, not pets."

- Implementing and maintaining Google Kubernetes Engine (GKE) clusters for all environments from development to production
- Built, scaled and maintained fully automatic infrastructure used from game backends to web apps
- Designed, developed and maintained software that formed the backbone of internal developer platform
- Actively reducing cloud costs, sometimes by up to 50% depending on the case
- Proactively documenting and mentoring.

Technologies used: Hashi stack (Terraform etc.), Ansible, Python, Bash, GKE, GCP, Kubernetes (K8s), Flux, ArgoCD, Helm, Kustomize, among many others

Infrastructure and application monitoring

"Providing the necessary 'single pane of glass view' of our infrastructure and application health"

- Architecting, implementing and maintaining a multi-site modern monitoring stack used for all environments from development to production
- Used Prometheus, Thanos, and Grafana for distributed metrics based monitoring and alerting
- Documentation, troubleshooting, onboarding

Technologies used: Prometheus, Thanos, Grafana

Continuous Integration / Delivery (CI/CD)

"Getting our products starting from developer nodes, through CI/CD, all the way to being released in mobile stores."

- CI/CD pipelining to automate building, testing and deployment to ship high quality products. Quickly, automatically, and reproducibly
- Building docker images used in pipelines and automations
- Tooling and scripting for any required automation. Build utility tooling, slack alerts, node clean ups, automated uploads
- Documentation, troubleshooting, and maintenance of pipelines

Technologies used: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Firebase, Fastlane, App Store & Google Play publishing, Python, Go

Professional Experience

Senior DevOps Engineer. 2025 - Present (MeisterLabs)

- Owned and developed replicable Kubernetes environments (development/staging/production)
- Implemented and moved both IaC & GitOps forward (ArgoCD for GitOps, Google Config Connector for IaC)
- Implemented canary rollout strategy for more frequent deployments (using ArgoCD rollouts)
- Built and maintained a modern observability platform (Prometheus based)
- Mentored other engineers in DevOps practises

DevOps Engineer. 2022 - 2025 (Critical Force)

- Implemented infrastructure as code with Terraform and Packer for developing and maintaining cloud infrastructure on GCP.
- Used Kubernetes (k8s) and Flux for automated GitOps style deployment of on-prem apps to the cloud.
- Oversaw CI/CD and monitoring vision of all company products as the head maintainer of GitLab CI/CD and in-house Prometheus stack.
- Developed REST APIs with Python for cataloging internal systems.
- Developed in-house development tooling with Python and Go for improving workflows.
- Maintained production runner fleet of 40+ nodes, heavily Linux and macOS, with some Windows.
- Automated build distribution with Fastlane, Firebase and Python.
- Provided docker images for Unity build pipelines run by GitLab CI/CD runners.
- Guided and onboarded other developers with solid documentation/ad-hoc support.
- Assisted in pipeline troubleshooting for both GitLab and Jenkins.
- Designed and implemented a modern monitoring stack used in multi-site & cloud (GCP, AWS).
- Demonstrated strong problem solving and proactive communication skills.
- Reduced cloud spending and build times to increase efficiency and profitability.

Player Support Specialist / Player Support Manager. 2020 - 2022 (Critical Force Oy)

- First role at Critical Force, transitioned to manager before moving to DevOps.
- Technical support for players.
- Workflow automation.

- LiveOps communication through product, and social media.
- Triaging high priority issues with developers.

Certifications

- Cisco Certified Network Associate (CCNA) – Routing & Switching (2022)

Education

- Self-completed course: Advanced Programming, 2022. Open University of Helsinki, Finland.
- Master's Degree in Learning & Educational Technology, 2020, University of Oulu, Finland.
- Bachelor's Degree in English Language Teaching, 2018. Hacettepe University, Turkey.